

SAT阅读推断题难题合集【学生版】

SAT Reading and Writing Questions

Converted to standardized website upload format | Module 1 and Module 2

Module 1

Question 2

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Many studies have found a positive association between levels of dissolved organic carbon and mercury in bodies of fresh water in North America. But Enelton Fagnani, José Roberto Guimara, and Pedro Sérgio Fadini did not find this correlation in a study conducted in Brazil, leading some scientists to hypothesize that the association is particular to North America. However, several other studies conducted outside North America, such as one by Rasmus Serensen and colleagues in Sweden, showed similar results to the North American studies, while few have produced results similar to those of Fagnani, Guimard, and Fadini's study, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text? A. the hypothesis that the positive association is particular to North America is correct. B. levels of dissolved organic carbon and mercury in bodies of freshwater are both much higher in Brazil than elsewhere. C. dissolved organic carbon and mercury levels do typically rise and fall together in fresh water. D. there were circumstances unique to Serensen and colleagues' study that impeded accurate measurements of mercury levels.

Question 3

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Quasars-such as CFHQS J2329-0301, located in the Pisces constellation-are extremely luminous galactic nuclei powered by supermassive black holes. Quasars range in age, with approximately 200 of them known to have developed within the first billion years of the formation of the universe. Cosmologists have long wondered how any quasars could have formed so early in the universe's evolution given that conditions are believed to have been ill-suited to their creation, which suggests that Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. CFHQS J2329-0301 is likely less massive than quasars that formed more than a billion years after the beginnings of the universe. most genera of moths that produce ultrasound capable of disrupting bat echolocation do so primarily for purposes other than evading capture by Arizona myotis and other predators.

B. CFHQS J2329-0301 is thought to have formed less than a billion years after the beginnings of the universe. the hypothesis about the development of this ultrasonic defense likely does not account for all instances of the trait in moths.

C. some aspect of the scientific understanding of quasar formation or the early universe may be incomplete. although previous findings about *Cynia tenera* are consistent with the hypothesis about the low metabolic cost of producing noxious chemicals, the ability to disrupt bat echolocation and unpalatability are not mutually exclusive traits.

D. quasars that formed in the early universe are likely not as luminous as those that formed later. To combat predation by Arizona myotis and other insectivorous bats, many moth species, including *Cynia tenera*, emit ultrasonic pulses that, in some cases, disrupt the echolocation bats rely on for foraging. Some scientists have hypothesized that this capability evolved because it imposes a lower metabolic cost than does the alternative mechanism of producing chemicals that render moths noxious to bats. Nicholas T. Homziak et al. investigated the acoustic properties of moths' ultrasonic responses to audio of bat echolocation and then assessed the palatability of the ultrasound-producing moths. They found that several moth genera that emit ultrasonic pulses capable of disrupting bat echolocation are unpalatable to bats, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text? further investigations into moths' ability to protect themselves by disrupting bat echolocation will likely find that moth genera relying on this mechanism are also generally inedible to bats.

Question 5

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Gottfried Schlaug et al. established that musical training is associated with physical alterations in the brain. Noting that such alterations may affect how sonic stimuli engender a hedonic response (a feeling of satisfaction and pleasure), Antonia Olivia Dolan et al. recently had musicians and nonmusicians listen to recordings-Led Zeppelin's "Whole Lotta Love," Jose Gonzalez's "Heartbeats," and others-and adjust the volume to the most pleasurable level for each recording. Although musicians and nonmusicians were clinically comparable in terms of their ability to detect sounds,

musicians preferred to hear the recordings at a higher volume than nonmusicians did, leading Dolan et al. to conclude that Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. previous research may have overstated the effects of the physical differences between musicians' brains and nonmusicians' brains.
- B. physical aspects of musicians' brains may suppress the hedonic response to music at volumes that provoke the hedonic response in nonmusicians.
- C. characteristics of musicians' brain anatomy that are not shared with nonmusicians result in musicians experiencing the hedonic response due to characteristics of music other than its volume.
- D. musical training may alter musicians' brains such that they have a reduced ability to detect sounds that are unlikely to incite the hedonic response.

Question 6

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Over 600 languages are spoken in New York City in addition to English—one can find Acehnese spoken in the neighborhood of Astoria, for example, or Hindi in Gramercy Park. English is the most common, with 65% of New Yorkers speaking it at home; Spanish is second, at 20%. A linguist hypothesizes that a Spanish dialect—a variation differing from the parent language in some of its vocabulary, pronunciation, and grammar—has developed in New York City, partly due to its linguistic interaction with English. Previous research shows that younger speakers of nonmajority languages are more likely to borrow words from the majority language of a region than are older speakers. If the linguist's hypothesis is correct, it is therefore likely to be the case that Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. younger speakers of Spanish in New York City would be more likely to use a dialect specific to New York City than older speakers living in the same neighborhood would be.
- B. the proportion of younger speakers who use a Spanish dialect specific to New York City is higher in neighborhoods where many languages are spoken than in neighborhoods where Spanish and English predominate.
- C. both the number of languages spoken in New York City and the number of dialects of each of those languages will increase over time.
- D. Spanish used by younger speakers in New York City tends to have more words borrowed from other nonmajority languages than borrowed from English.

Question 7

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An analysis by Alain Elayi and colleagues of coins minted in Sidon in the fifth and fourth centuries BCE reveals a change in their composition over time: while a coin from circa 450 BCE contains about 98% silver and 1% copper, a coin from 367 BCE (the end of Ba'alsillem II's reign) contains 74.2% silver and 24.7% copper, giving it a relatively yellowish appearance that traders would have noticed. Because coins with a silver content below 80% were widely considered unsuitable for trade, Elayi et al. speculate that a crisis in confidence in the currency occurred in Sidon around 367 BCE, which was likely relieved—despite Sidon's persistent oppressive financial obligations—as a result of Ba'alsillem II's successor Abd'astart I's decision to Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. keep the amount of silver in Sidonian coins consistent with that in coins minted in 367 BCE but decrease their weight.
- B. proclaim that the percentage of silver in coins suitable for trade would be raised to a threshold higher than 80%.
- C. fund the mining of some copper deposits that were not available to Ba'alsillem II.
- D. begin minting heavier coins with a proportion of silver to copper similar to that in coins minted in 367 BCE.

Question 8

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British professional soccer team Arsenal Football Club, whose home uniform color is mainly red, won more than half its home matches between 1947 and 2003. This is a higher proportion than the proportion of home matches won by Watford Football Club, whose home uniform color is not red, during the same period. According to a study by Martin J. Attrill and colleagues, the color red can cause people to respond with fear and hesitation, which the researchers think helps explain Arsenal's success. Nadav Goldschmied and colleagues reanalyzed the published data from this study, however, and found no evidence that red-uniformed teams are more likely than other teams to win, suggesting that Watford's home-match win percentage Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. would likely have remained roughly the same if its players had been wearing red uniforms.
- B. may have influenced other teams to change their uniform colors.

- C. was directly tied to its players' general satisfaction with their uniform color.
- D. was likely influenced by its players' associations with the color red.

Question 9

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Sheffield United Football Club won more than half its home matches between 1947 and 2003, helping to distinguish the team as a top British professional soccer club. Additionally, Sheffield United, whose home uniform color is mainly red, was more successful in home matches than was Cardiff City Football Club, whose home uniform color is not red. Research has shown that many people associate the color red with power and dominance. Past experiences with red objects such as stop signs can even cause people to respond to the color red with caution and hesitation. These findings, if applicable in the context of athletic competitions, could suggest that in matches played at Sheffield United's home stadium, opponents may have

- Which choice most logically completes the text?
- A. been unaffected by the red clothing worn by fans in the stadium.
- B. played more aggressively than they would have if their own uniforms were red.
- C. been influenced by the color of Sheffield United's uniforms.
- D. been aware that Sheffield United's uniform color affected their own performance.

Question 10

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Studies have shown that when we listen to high-tempo music (songs with a high number of beats per minute, or bpm) during endurance exercise, we perceive our effort as lower than it actually is, which leads to an increased pace and a higher heart rate. Researchers recently designed a follow-up study in which participants jogged outdoors for 30 minutes while listening to Aerosmith's "Livin' on the Edge" (169 bpm) continuously. The next day participants performed the same activity while listening to Beyonce's "Irreplaceable" (88 bpm). As expected, listening to that song resulted in participants

- Which choice most logically completes the text?
- A. perceiving their effort as higher while jogging than they had the previous day.
- B. jogging a longer distance in the 30 minutes than they had the previous day.
- C. varying their jogging pace more than they had the previous day.
- D. exhibiting a higher average heart rate while jogging than they had the previous day.

Question 11

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Exclusively inhabiting tropical countries such as Sierra Leone, wild chimpanzees lack adaptations to seasonal variations in ultraviolet B (UVB) irradiance from sunlight; since UVB exposure enables vertebrates to synthesize vitamin D, this raises questions about how chimpanzees in mid-latitude zoos are affected by the lower and more variable UVB irradiance in those locations. In a study of zoo chimpanzees in Sweden and other mid-latitude countries, Sophie Moittié and colleagues found not only that chimpanzees' vitamin D levels correlate with UVB irradiance but also that vitamin D levels show no evidence of plateauing as UVB irradiance reaches its highest local levels, suggesting that

- Which choice most logically completes the text?
- A. averaged across seasons, vitamin D levels in zoo chimpanzees in mid-latitude countries such as Sweden tend to be comparable to those in wild chimpanzees in tropical countries such as Sierra Leone. fail to consider the ways in which the survival of *M. anniana* may be influenced by changes in the populations of other species that inhabit Tamaulipas.
- B. adaptations to seasonal variations in UVB irradiance may be emerging in zoo chimpanzees in Sweden and other mid-latitude countries. erroneously shift the focus of conservation efforts away from *M. anniana* itself.
- C. providing supplemental vitamin D to chimpanzees in zoos in Sweden and other mid-latitude countries would likely not be beneficial. lead to a better understanding of how the distribution of *Mammillaria* species throughout Mexico has affected their survival.
- D. zoo chimpanzees in Sweden and other mid-latitude countries tend to synthesize less vitamin D than they are inherently capable of synthesizing. The *Mammillaria* cactus *M. anniana* occurs naturally only in the state of Tamaulipas in Mexico, and the smallness of its range makes it especially vulnerable to extinction. The traditional single-species approach to conservation emphasizes the need to focus on individual species most at risk, like *M. anniana*, but recently, conservationists have argued that an ecosystem-based approach that incorporates the many interactions between the climate, terrain, and various species of a given geographical area may lead to better outcomes for all the species in a given location. If this view is correct, the single-species approach to the conservation of *M. anniana* could thus

choice most logically completes the text? allow conservationists to better consider how climatic changes affecting Tamaulipas may reduce the number of species competing with *M. anniana*.

Question 13

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Like many other genera of wild bees, bumblebees have in recent decades experienced population collapse caused by, among other factors, habitat destruction and climate variation. Bumblebees are also one of the most researched bee genera, second only to honeybees. As a result, ecologists have gained much of their insight about wild-bee declines from bumblebees. In a 2021 paper, zoologist Guillaume Ghisbain notes that bumblebees are among the relatively few wild-bee genera that display social behaviors and dietary generalism (ability to obtain nectar and pollen from a diversity of plant species), two traits that are associated with increased resilience to some specific environmental changes. Ghisbain therefore contends that Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. although bumblebees have been more extensively studied than most wild bees, researchers should not use bumblebees to draw conclusions about the decline of other wild bees, even ones with feeding patterns and levels of sociability that are similar to those of bumblebees. some studies of amphibians found larger effects of exposure to anthropogenic noise than some studies of mammals did.
- B. because bumblebees and other bees with generalist diets are less negatively affected by environmental stress than bees with specialized diets are, they are less likely to experience major population changes in the future than bees with specialized diets are. the studies in the meta-analysis that examined mammals were more likely than those that examined amphibians to specify whether the observed effects were detrimental.
- C. because the responses of bumblebees and other wild bees to environmental threats are not always comparable, researchers need to exercise caution when extrapolating information about wild-bee population declines from bumblebees. the differences that studies attribute to exposure to anthropogenic noise are likely to be more pronounced for amphibians than they are for mammals.
- D. although bumblebees and many other wild bees have experienced similar population declines in the past, compared with bumblebees, other wild bees may decline much more quickly due to their specialized diet in the future. Prolonged exposure to anthropogenic noise (sounds from human sources like traffic or mining) can affect animals, as Debra M. Shier and colleagues found in a 2012 study of Stephens kangaroo rats. Researchers conducted a meta-analysis of studies of how such noise affects animals and found that, for every study, relevant traits or behaviors of the animals were observably different between the exposed group and the otherwise similar but unexposed group. Although, on average, studies of mammals showed larger differences than studies of amphibians did, for every class of animals examined, there were individual studies showing differences well above the average for mammals. Therefore, the results of the meta-analysis suggest that Which choice most logically completes the text? the difference found in the study conducted by Debra M. Shier and colleagues was likely larger than the average difference for studies of Stephens kangaroo rats included in the meta-analysis.

Question 15

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Many Indian snack foods, such as bhatoora and paneer pakora, acquire their flavor from being fried in oil; some are also coated in batter beforehand. Chemists Marc A. Meyers and Andrew Grazele studied the mass and heat transfer processes that occur when foods are fried in batters containing hydrocolloids, polymers that become viscous or gel-like in water. During frying, water in the food evaporates, leaving voids that oil (a pure fat) can fill. As the process continues, water from the food's center moves to the crust as long as the crust remains permeable. However, hydrocolloids can create structures in the crust that reduce the transfer of moisture out of the food's core during frying. Therefore, a food fried without a hydrocolloid batter coating will likely , Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. have a more viscous crust when frying is completed than it would have if it were fried with a coating of hydrocolloid batter. there is greater corroboration in the archaeological record of ecological practices described in Kwakwaka'wakw songs than of those described in Temiar and Tlingit songs.
- B. have a higher fat content than it would have if it were fried with a coating of hydrocolloid batter. non-Indigenous people around the Pacific Northwest coast adopted the practice developed by the Kwakwaka'wakw people after observing its efficacy.
- C. need to be cooked more quickly at a higher temperature than it would need to be cooked if it were fried with a coating of hydrocolloid batter. although contemporary Kwakwaka'wakw people have a deep understanding of and appreciation for the fishing and farming practices used by their ancestors, they no longer implement those methods
- D. need to be cooked in a different oil than it would need to be cooked in if it were fried with a coating of hydrocolloid

batter. Scholars are increasingly exploring the communication and preservation of ecological knowledge through Indigenous songs (e.g., Temiar songs about landforms and landmarks and those of the Tlingit people about wildlife encounters). In one study, ethnobiologist Dana Lepofsky et al. Received insight from Kwaxsi'tla Wathl'thla, a song keeper for the Kwakwaka'wakw people in Canada, into songs referencing the people's use of terraced gardens in intertidal zones along the Pacific Northwest coast for the cultivation of clams for consumption. Archaeological evidence of significant increases in clam size and abundance in that area concurrent with the documented past implementation of the method described in the songs supports the conclusion that Which choice most logically completes the text? the practice used by ancestors of modern Kwakwaka'wakw people not only effectively maintained a food source but also promoted its robustness.

Question 17

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For its 1974 work *Instant Mural*, the Chicano art collective Asco taped members Patssi Valdez and Humberto Sandoval to an outdoor wall in East Los Angeles. The work is manifestly a commentary on constraint, but many critics focus on Valdez and the social constraints women faced at the time, which is understandable but leaves the presence of Valdez's male collaborator Sandoval unexplained. We should instead consider that in 1974, the art establishment's recognition of Chicano artists was (and had long been) restricted to sociohistorical muralists, leaving nonmuralist Chicano artists-like Asco's members-struggling to even exhibit their work; attending to this context opens an interpretation that accounts for all the evidence, allowing us to conclude that Which choice most logically completes the text? A. while Valdez's presence in *Instant Mural* represents the social constraints placed on women at the time, Sandoval's presence represents Chicano muralists' frustration at their lack of recognition by the art establishment. B. the main subject of *Instant Mural* is female Chicano artists' experience of being doubly constrained by gender-role expectations and the marginalization of certain types of art. C. *Instant Mural* is best understood not as a critique of the social constraints placed on women but rather as a critique of sociohistorical muralists' depictions of Chicano culture. D. *Instant Mural* is a reflection on the constraining aesthetic expectations placed on Chicano artists in general rather than on the social constraints placed on women specifically.

Question 18

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Chelsea Wood et al. tracked temperature-driven changes in the abundance of *Opechona* sp. (a complex life cycle parasite, or CLP, that requires three host species throughout its life cycle), *Anthocotyle merluccii* (a directly transmitted parasite, which requires only one host species), and 83 other parasite taxa found on eight fish species. CLPs are transmitted when an infected host is ingested by an individual of another species, typically shielding CLPs from the external environment, whereas directly transmitted parasites are exposed to external conditions during transmission. However, Wood et al. found that three-host CLP abundance decreased as sea temperatures rose, whereas directly transmitted parasite abundance was largely stable, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. CLPs primarily transmitted by ingestion were less dependent on host species adversely affected by warming temperatures than were CLPs that use other transmission strategies. population size and density of the eight fish species examined in the study were likely largely unaffected by rising sea temperatures.
- B. as the number of host species involved in a parasite's transmission increases, the parasite is better protected against rising temperatures. although *Anisakis* sp. and *C. parophrysi* both require walleye pollock as a host, *C. parophrysi* was more adversely affected by warming-driven changes in the walleye pollock population than *Anisakis* sp. was.
- C. directly transmitted parasites identified in the study were more likely to use transmission strategies that shield them from warming temperatures than were three-host CLPs. a parasite's sensitivity to warming temperatures is negatively correlated with the number of unique vertebrate species it depends on throughout its life cycle.
- D. any advantages that the transmission strategy used by three-host CLPs may have conferred did not completely offset the negative effects of other temperature-driven factors on CLP abundance. As complex life cycle parasites, *Anisakis* sp. and *Capillaria parophrysi* require multiple host species throughout their development. Extrapolating from parasite counts on walleye pollock and seven other fish species collected from Puget Sound from 1880 to 2019, Chelsea Wood et al. found that the abundance of three-host parasites, such as *Anisakis* sp., negatively correlated with rising average annual sea temperatures; the abundance of two-host parasites, such as *C. parophrysi*, was largely stable. Noting that fish and other marine vertebrates are especially vulnerable to climate change, Wood et al. observed that all three-host parasites in the study depend on at least two vertebrate species, while all two-host parasites depend on only one, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text? warming-induced population changes among Puget Sound vertebrates may have suppressed some parasite populations, but there were no changes among the eight studied host species that affected two-host parasite abundance.

Question 20

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To understand consumer loyalty to specific online retailers, Marina Zizakov and colleagues conducted a survey using 58 statements as proxy indicators of customer experience with receiving online purchases. The statements were categorized by topic-e.g., statement 13, “I am eagerly awaiting the delivery of the ordered items,” was categorized as joyful anticipation-and respondents, all of whom were from Serbia (which is characterized as having a developing economy), rated the importance of each statement to their experience. Researchers found that participants placed low importance on package aesthetics and high importance on speedy delivery and package tracking, but the researchers cautioned against applying the findings to customers generally, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. additional research is needed with participants from countries of varying levels of economic development to determine whether delivery time and tracking are more important than package design to customers broadly. Coatlan Mixe and the other languages of the Mixe branch likely supplanted the a lake existed at the Murray Formation for a prolonged period, though the lake occasionally experienced drying and there were periods in which one or more streams were present. investment growth is likely to be more consistent in countries that liberalize than in countries that do not. companies in Malaysia experienced a greater increase in investment following liberalization than did companies in the Philippines.

B. customers in countries with higher levels of economic development than that of Serbia are likely to regard package design as relatively more important than delivery time and transparency. the Mixe-Zoquean family had already diverged into the Mixe and Zoque branches by the time the Olmecs became the prevailing power in the region. one or more streams existed at the Murray Formation for an extended period until being replaced by a lake that persisted for only a brief period before permanently drying. companies typically do not benefit from liberalization until at least three years after liberalization occurs. economists who held the standard view of liberalization failed to anticipate some serious negative effects of liberalization.

C. online retailers that operate in a variety of countries are more likely to increase customer loyalty if they make their deliveries in less time and allow customers to track those deliveries than if they improve their packaging. the language of the Olmec civilization contributed words not only to Mayan languages but also to other languages in the Mixe-Zoquean family. a stream-fed lake was present at the Murray Formation for an extended period, and although the streams experienced occasional drying, the lake did not. economists’ expectations about the effect of liberalization on investment were largely correct. companies did not benefit from liberalization until at least three years after liberalization occurred.

D. the greater importance assigned to delivery time and tracking than to package design may not be observed if the survey were to be given to a larger group of Serbian participants. Although the language of the Olmec civilization, which flourished in southern Mexico Mixe-Zoquean family, a group of related languages whose present-day representatives are spoken in an area corresponding to ancient Olmec sites. The family can be subdivided into a Zoque branch, which includes Copainala Zoque, and a Mixe branch, which includes Coatlan Mixe. Many words in the Mayan languages-languages spoken in the region but otherwise unrelated to the Mixe-Zoquean family-are Mixe-Zoquean in origin and were likely borrowed during the period when the Olmecs dominated the entire area. Tellingly, all those words derive from the Zoque branch, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text? the language of the Olmec civilization was likely the founding language of the family that includes Mayan languages. Data collected by the Mars rover Curiosity at the Gale Crater’s Murray Formation are suggestive of hydrological deposition of sediment in the distant past. To characterize the nature of the depositional environment, Frances Rivera-Hernandez et al, analyzed the grain size of Murray Formation sediment, finding that although there are intervals of coarse grains, most of the sediment consists of fine grains that show signs of cracking due to episodic desiccation. Rivera-Hernandez et al. concluded that the coarse grains are sandstone, which tends to be deposited by flowing water, whereas the fine grains are mudstone, which is slowly deposited by settling out of suspension in low-flow water, leading the researchers to posit that Which choice most logically completes the text? although the area of the Murray Formation experienced a prolonged period of dryness that prevented a lake from forming, water flowing from a distant source was present. In May of 1987, Malaysia liberalized its stock market, meaning that it began allowing foreign individuals and businesses to invest money in Malaysian companies. This was part of a wave of stock market liberalizations from the mid-1980s through the mid-1990s-Thailand in 1988, Mexico in 1989, and so on. In an analysis of economic data from 1976 to 1993, Ross Levine and Sara Zervos found that liberalization did not lead to enduring increases in investment in companies based in countries that liberalized. Peter Blair Henry, however, found that, on average, investment in companies in liberalized countries increased significantly in the three years following liberalization. Taken together, these results suggest that Which choice most logically completes the text? liberalization may provide a boost to investment that fades over time. In May of 1986, the Philippines liberalized its stock market, meaning that it began allowing foreign individuals and businesses to invest money in Filipino companies. This was part of a wave of stock market liberalizations around the

world-Malaysia in 1987, Morocco in 1988, and so on. The standard view among economists at the time was that liberalization would make it easier for companies to raise money from investors. Economist Peter Blair Henry examined the economies of 11 countries that were part of the liberalization wave and found that, on average, companies based in those countries received significant increases in investment in the three years following liberalization, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text? empirical evidence was consistent with the scholarly consensus about the consequences of liberalization.

Question 25

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Mongolia, which, according to international indices, has relatively strong democratic institutions and low intranational income inequality, experienced an inflation rate of

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30% in 2017, whereas Cameroon, which shows the opposite pattern on such indices, had an inflation rate of only 0.64% that year. Such comparisons have engendered speculation that by diluting control over the economy, democratic institutions inhibit states' ability to counteract inflationary pressures. To test this possibility systematically, Raj Desai et al. examined democratic strength, intranational inequality, and inflation in more than 100 countries, finding that democratic strength, if associated with low inequality, restrains inflationary pressures, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. it would be a mistake to treat the relative inflation rates of Mongolia and Cameroon as indicative of an inherent shortcoming in democratic institutions with regard to control over inflation.
- B. speculations about the relative inability of democratic institutions to counteract inflation are based on measures that tend to exaggerate the levels of inflation in strongly democratic countries such as Mongolia.
- C. the factors that contributed to Mongolia's elevated inflation rate relative to Cameroon's have less to do with the countries' political institutions than with the countries' levels of income inequality.
- D. the difference between Mongolia and Cameroon with regard to democratic institution strength may have been greater in 2017 than was represented by international indices.

Question 26

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With the ongoing expansion of e-commerce, consumers are expecting faster and faster delivery of goods, but delivery companies continue to struggle with last-mile logistics (the final step in delivery to consumers) due to challenges such as complex and inefficient delivery routes. Innovations to mitigate these challenges have been emerging-the use of autonomous delivery robots, for example-but these innovations tend to engender their own complications (e.g., robots travel relatively slowly since they must navigate many ground-level obstacles), leading researchers to conclude that Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. there may not be sufficient incentive for delivery companies to attempt to solve the problems associated with last-mile logistics.
- B. consumers' expectations for reduced delivery times may be outstripping what is viable for delivery companies to provide.
- C. a better understanding of consumers' expectations for delivery is needed so that companies can better plan for fluctuations in delivery volume.
- D. rapid delivery is a leading factor in consumer satisfaction, and therefore delivery companies would benefit from investing resources in reducing delivery times.

Question 27

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The Clarion-Clipperton Zone (CCZ) is an expanse of abyssal plain and seamounts (underwater mountains) between Hawai'i and Mexico in which mining is permitted, but the area's biodiversity is poorly understood. The vast majority of invertebrate species found in a recent survey of the CCZ were hitherto unknown to scientists, and sampling for animal life has been highly concentrated in the eastern part of the zone. Some species like *Ledella knudseni* were identified both morphologically and molecularly (using DNA analysis), whereas *Prionospio branchilucida* and other species for

which molecular sampling was impracticable were identified solely based on physical morphology. Since molecular analysis does not require distinguishing subtle physiological differences, it is Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. more likely to properly distinguish between morphologically similar but distinct invertebrate species than is the method used to identify *Prionospio branchilucida*.
- B. more frequently used for identifying species with physiological characteristics like those of *Ledella knudseni* than morphological analysis is.
- C. better suited to distinguishing *Prionospio branchilucida* from morphologically similar species than to distinguishing *Ledella knudseni* from morphologically similar species.
- D. capable of providing greater physiological detail about a species than is the method used for *Prionospio branchilucida*.

Question 28

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All stainless steel contains varying amounts of iron, carbon, and corrosion-inhibiting chromium. However, ferritic stainless steel, often used for cooking utensils, contains a higher percentage of chromium (at least 10.5%) than does austenitic stainless steel and a higher concentration of iron, which is responsible for its magnetic properties. Unlike ferritic stainless steel, austenitic stainless steel has a face-centered cubic crystalline structure resulting from the addition of nickel to the alloy. Austenitic stainless steel has two subtypes: the 200 series, often used for washing machines, and the 300 series, which has more nickel than the 200 series and is often used for mining and chemical equipment or compensators. Thus, stainless steel used to manufacture Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. cooking utensils will have greater magnetic properties than stainless steel used to manufacture mining and chemical equipment will.
- B. mining and chemical equipment will have a concentration of chromium lower than

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5%, while stainless steel used for washing machines will not. C. cooking utensils will have a face-centered cubic crystalline structure. D. compensators will likely have a similar crystalline structure to stainless steel used to manufacture cooking utensils.

Question 29

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All stainless steel contains varying amounts of iron, carbon, and corrosion-inhibiting chromium. However, ferritic stainless steel often used for induction cookers contains a higher percentage of chromium (at least 10.5%) than does austenitic stainless steel as well as a higher concentration of iron. Unlike ferritic stainless steel, austenitic stainless steel has a face-centered cubic crystalline structure held stable by the presence of nickel and nitrogen. Austenitic stainless steel has two subtypes: the 200 series, often used for washing machines, and the 300 series, which has more nickel than the 200 series and is often used for storage containers or furnaces. Thus, stainless steel used to manufacture Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. furnaces and stainless steel used to manufacture washing machines will both have a chromium content of less than 10.5%.
- B. washing machines will have a higher concentration of nickel in its composition than stainless steel used to manufacture furnaces will.
- C. induction cookers will have a face-centered cubic crystalline structure, but stainless steel used to manufacture storage containers will not.
- D. storage containers and stainless steel used to manufacture induction cookers will have a similar concentration of nitrogen in their compositions.

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Source PDF page: 31

All stainless steel contains varying amounts of iron, carbon, and corrosion-inhibiting chromium. However, ferritic stainless steel, often used for induction cookers, contains a higher percentage of chromium (at least 10.5%) than does austenitic stainless steel and a higher concentration of iron, which is responsible for its magnetic properties. Unlike ferritic stainless steel, austenitic stainless steel has a face-centered cubic crystalline structure resulting from the addition of nickel to the alloy. Austenitic stainless steel has two subtypes: the 300 series, often used for storage containers, and the 200 series, which has less nickel and more manganese than the 300 series and is used for indoor architecture. Thus, stainless steel used to manufacture storage containers will have

- Which choice most logically completes the text?
- A. similar magnetic properties to stainless steel used to manufacture induction cookers.
 - B. a concentration of manganese greater than 10.5%, while stainless steel used to manufacture indoor architecture will not.
 - C. a face-centered cubic crystalline structure, while stainless steel used to manufacture induction cookers will not.
 - D. a lower percentage of nickel in its composition than stainless steel used to manufacture induction cookers will.

Question 31

Source PDF page: 32

All stainless steel contains varying amounts of iron, carbon, and corrosion-inhibiting chromium. However, ferritic stainless steel, often used for induction cookers, contains a higher percentage of chromium (at least 10.5%) than does austenitic stainless steel and a higher concentration of iron, which is responsible for its magnetic properties. Unlike ferritic stainless steel, austenitic stainless steel has a face-centered cubic crystalline structure resulting from the addition of nickel to the alloy. Austenitic stainless steel has two subtypes: the 300 series, often used for aerospace tubing, and the 200 series, which has less nickel and more manganese than the 300 series and is used for dishwashers. Thus, stainless steel used to manufacture

- Which choice most logically completes the text?
- A. aerospace tubing will have similar magnetic properties to stainless steel used to manufacture induction cookers. anti-bat ultrasound production may be a more prevalent defense strategy among large-bodied moths than previously known to researchers.
 - B. both aerospace tubing and dishwashers will have a face-centered cubic crystalline structure, but stainless steel used to manufacture aerospace tubing will have less nickel than stainless steel used to manufacture dishwashers will. ultrasound production is only one of a diverse range of effective strategies moths employ to evade bat attacks.
 - C. aerospace tubing will have a concentration of manganese greater than 10.5%, while stainless steel used to manufacture dishwashers will not. unlike the 52 moth genera that emit ultrasonic clicks, most moth genera have likely not developed defenses specifically against bat attacks.
 - D. aerospace tubing will have less manganese in its composition than stainless steel used to manufacture dishwashers will. The jade hawkmoth, a large-bodied moth, defends itself against the eastern red bat and other insect-eating bats, which use echolocation to hunt, by emitting ultrasonic clicks that can, for instance, disrupt the bats' echolocation signals. To investigate moths' defensive ultrasound—which researchers had thought was exclusive to tiger moths, hawkmoths, and one species of geometer moths—Akito Y. Kawahara et al. recorded the responses of moths from 252 genera, representing most families of large-bodied moths, to audio playback of bat echolocation. The researchers found that 52 of the genera, including several genera belonging to the geometer family, produced defensive ultrasonic clicks. This result suggests that
- some genera of large-bodied moths may use ultrasonic signaling for purposes other than avoiding capture by predators such as the eastern red bat.

Question 33

Source PDF page: 34

Evan MacLean and colleagues evaluated behavioral and genetic data from over 14,000 dogs, representing more than 100 breeds, and found that variations in behavior between breeds can be attributed to genetic variations between those breeds, suggesting a genetic basis for breed differences in behavior. This was the case for both separation problems and dog rivalry but was especially pronounced for attachment and attention-seeking, which can be seen when a dog solicits affection or attention. In a different study, researchers found that, with regard to attachment and attention-seeking, the French bulldog behaves in notably different ways than the cairn terrier. Together, these findings imply that

- Which choice most logically completes the text?
- A. the French bulldog and the cairn terrier differ with respect to the genetic underpinnings for attachment and attention-seeking.
 - B. the French bulldog and the cairn terrier will likely become more genetically similar over time.

- C. French bulldogs and cairn terriers show a greater tendency toward attachment and attention-seeking than most other dog breeds do.
- D. individual French bulldogs may display higher levels of attachment and attention-seeking than individual cairn terriers.

Question 34

Source PDF page: 35

Evan MacLean and colleagues evaluated behavioral and genetic data from over 14,000 dogs, representing more than 100 breeds, and found that certain similarities in behavior between breeds correspond to genetic similarities between those breeds, suggesting a genetic basis for breed differences in behavior. This was the case for both dog rivalry and energy but was especially pronounced for chasing, which can be seen when a dog pursues small animals like birds or squirrels. A different study found that the French bulldog and the bullmastiff breeds exhibit similar chasing behavior, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. their similarities with respect to that behavior could result from a shared aspect of their genetics.
- B. individual French bulldogs likely display higher levels of chasing than individual bullmastiffs.
- C. French bulldogs and bullmastiffs show a greater tendency toward chasing than most other dog breeds do.
- D. the two breeds will likely become less genetically similar over time.

Question 35

Source PDF page: 36

The morphological novelty of echinoderms-marine invertebrates with radial symmetry usually starlike, around a central point-impedes comparisons with most other animals, in which bilateral symmetry on an anterior-posterior (head to tail) axis through a trunk is typical. Particularly puzzling are sea stars, thought to have evolved a headless layout from a known bilateral origin. Applying genomic knowledge of *Saccoglossus kowalevskii* acorn worms (close relatives of sea stars, and thus expected to have similar markers for corresponding anatomical regions) to the body patterning genes of *Patiria miniata* sea stars, Laurent Formery et al. observed activity only in anterior genes across *P. miniata*'s entire body and some posterior genes limited to the edges, suggesting that Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. despite the greater prevalence of anterior genes in sea stars' genetic makeup, posterior genes active at the body's perimeter are primarily responsible for the starlike layout that distinguishes sea stars' radial symmetry from that of other echinoderms.
- B. although the two species are closely related, there is only minimal correspondence in the genetic markers for head, tail, and trunk region development in *P. miniata* sea stars and *S. kowalevskii* acorn worms.
- C. rather than undergoing changes resulting in the eventual elimination of a head region in their radial body plan, as previously assumed, sea stars' morphology evolved to completely lack a trunk and consist primarily of a head region.
- D. contrary to the belief that they evolved from early ancestors with the bilateral form typical of many other animals, sea stars instead originated. with an atypical body layout that was neither bilaterally nor radially symmetrical.

Question 36

Source PDF page: 37

Many contemporary Indigenous painters practice a specifically Indigenous mode of abstraction: for example, Linda Lomahaftewa often assembles compositions out of motifs common in the ceramics and other traditional arts of the Hopi Tribe. In contrast, the prominent Indigenous practitioners of abstract painting during the mid-twentieth century, such as the Kiowa artist T. C. Cannon, typically aligned their compositional strategies with Abstract Expressionism-a school of painting dominated by European American artists-instead of with traditionally nonrepresentational forms of Indigenous art. Thus, in the case of Cannon's generation, the identification of an abstract painting as Indigenous art tends to Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. depend not on stylistic details but instead on an awareness of the artist's identity.
- B. place a greater emphasis on the artist's biography than on the aesthetic merit of the painting.
- C. obscure the Indigenous origins of certain motifs associated with Abstract Expressionism.
- D. deny the extent to which cultural identity influences an artist's work.

Question 37

Source PDF page: 38

Nella Larsen's 1928 novel *Quicksand* is regularly described as autobiographical. That characterization is apt—there are many parallels between the experiences of the novel's protagonist, Helga Crane, and those of Larsen—but it should not be taken to mean that all the people and events depicted in *Quicksand* are based on actual people and events. The novel is largely pure invention, and readers who neglect this fact and instead try to identify more and more real-life analogues thus risk Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. positing unsupportable connections between *Quicksand* and Larsen's life.
- B. misrepresenting *Quicksand* as being more widely read than it actually is.
- C. minimizing the fact that Larsen drew on real-world material when writing *Quicksand*.
- D. overemphasizing the extent to which Larsen took inspiration from earlier writers.

Question 38

Source PDF page: 39

the many editions of James Joyce's 1922 novel *Ulysses* are not textually identical, and scholars debate which versions reflect Joyce's authorial intent. One no longer widely read edition is the 1984 "critical and synoptic edition" edited by Hans Walter Gabler, which followed French and German editorial theories rather than editorial traditions of the United States and United Kingdom and which was later found to have introduced errors due to Gabler's choice to consult facsimile manuscripts rather than using only originals. However, few Joyce scholars worldwide had expertise in such textual issues, and most of those who did worked on the edition with Gabler. So, it is unsurprising that initial scholarly reviews of the 1984 edition were mostly Which choice most logically completes the text? A. positive, since *Ulysses* is a novel in English and the 1984 edition would therefore be more widely reviewed in United States and United Kingdom publications than in French and German publications. B. negative, since any scholar with expertise in editorial theories of the United States and United Kingdom as well as French and German editorial theories most likely worked with Gabler on the 1984 edition and would therefore not review it. C. negative, since those Joyce scholars with the necessary expertise to write a review of the 1984 edition would be aware that facsimile manuscripts cannot be produced with a high enough fidelity to the original to ensure that relying on them will not introduce editorial errors. D. positive, since scholars who reviewed the 1984 edition were unaffiliated with its production and were mostly either Joyce specialists who were largely unfamiliar with editorial theories and practices or specialists in such theories and practices who were insufficiently familiar with Joyce.

Question 39

Source PDF page: 40

Some ethicists hold that the moral goodness of an individual's actions depends solely on whether the actions themselves are good, irrespective of the context in which they are carried out. Philosopher L. Sebastian Purcell has shown that surviving works of Aztec (Nahua) philosophy express a very different view. Purcell reveals that these works posit an ethical system in which an individual's actions are judged in light of how well they accord with the individual's role in society and how well they contribute to the community. To the extent that these works are representative of Aztec thought, Purcell's analysis suggests that Which choice most logically completes the text? A. the Aztecs would have disputed the idea that the morality of an individual's actions can be assessed by appealing to standards of behavior that are independent of the individual's social circumstances. B. the Aztecs would not have accepted the notion that the morality of an individual's actions can be fairly evaluated by people who do not live in the same society as that individual. C. actions by members of Aztec society who contributed a great deal to their community could be judged as morally good even if those actions were inconsistent with behaviors the Aztecs regarded as good in all contexts. D. similar actions performed by people in different social roles in Aztec society would have been regarded as morally equivalent unless those actions led to different outcomes for the community.

Question 40

Source PDF page: 41

The Bronze Age in Britain lasted from around 2500 BCE to approximately 700 BCE. Collections of metal items (called hoards) from all periods of the Bronze Age have been found in Britain, including the Arretton Down hoard of artifacts from the 17th century BCE, unearthed around 1735, and the much later Hollingbourne hoard of artifacts from the 10th century BCE, unearthed around 2003. Sometime in the Middle Bronze Age (approximately from the 14th century BCE to the 10th century BCE), metalsmiths in Britain began to develop swords for the first time. This fact helps explain why, whereas evidence of sword production was found in Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. both the Arreton Down hoard and the Hollingbourne hoard, only the latter included evidence of more refined sword production.
- B. hoards discovered before 2003, no such evidence was found in hoards that were discovered later. users' intentions to pay for premium streaming services are probably unaffected by factors other than performance expectancy. C.it may be advantageous for music streaming companies to try to influence the extent to which potential users perceive the use of the premium version to be beneficial.
- C. the Arreton Down hoard, no intact swords were found among the items in the hoard.
- D. the Hollingbourne hoard, no such evidence was found in the Arreton Down hoard. Mariana Lopes Barata and Pedro Simoes Coelho collected data from 324 music-streaming service users to identify factors that influence users to opt for paid (premium) versions of music streaming services, like Apple Music. They hypothesized that performance expectancy (how much the use of a service is perceived to benefit the consumer) would be positively correlated with users' intentions to adopt premium versions. The researchers asked participants to rate statements such as "Using paid music streaming services increases my productivity." They found that, indeed, performance expectancy positively influences the intention to adopt premium streaming service versions, which suggests that Which choice most logically completes the text? A.he statement "Using paid music streaming services increases my productivity" is not a reliable measure of performance expectancy. participants who strongly agreed with the statement "Using paid music streaming services increases my productivity" were more likely to express loyalty to Apple Music than to other streaming services.

Question 42

Source PDF page: 43

- Saeed M.Z.A. Tarabieh conducted a study of consumer attitudes toward Jordanian food and beverage companies and found that for consumers who value environmental conservation, their likelihood of purchasing a product decreased when their perception of the product's risk of causing environmental harm increased. Subsequently, other researchers conducted a study of various demographic groups in Turkey, investigating participants' intentions to purchase a new skin-care product, and found that, on average, parents of small children had the lowest perception among all the demographic groups in the study of the environmental risks of the skin-care product. Assuming that the results of Tarabieh's study are broadly applicable, this finding suggests that Which choice most logically completes the text?
- A. the new skin-care product is less appealing to parents of small children than other similar products on the market are.
- B. there is not a meaningful difference in the average likelihood of purchasing environmentally friendly products among the demographic groups included in the study.
- C. parents of small children likely prioritize other factors over a product's environmental sustainability when making purchasing decisions.
- D. parents of small children might be more likely than participants in the other demographic groups to purchase the skin-care product.

Question 43

Source PDF page: 44

- Previous research has shown that plant species with a narrow geographical range tend to be more genetically homogeneous than plant species with extensive ranges are. Based on these findings, researchers recently ran simulations to predict how the genetic variation of several species of *Mammillaria*, a genus of cactus found throughout the Americas, might change in different distribution conditions. One of these species, *M. anniana*, is found only in the state of Tamaulipas. The researchers simulated what would happen if *M. anniana* spread to new habitats outside Tamaulipas, and, consistent with previous findings, the results showed that Which choice most logically completes the text?
- A. there was a gradual increase in the genetic homogeneity of *Mammillaria* species in states neighboring Tamaulipas. Malory did not use Englynion y Beddau as a source for information he presented about the Round Table. B
- B. *Mammillaria* species other than *M. anniana* would become more common in Tamaulipas. Geoffrey of Monmouth's accounts of Arthurian legends in his *History* are more similar overall in content to the accounts in *Sir Gawain and the Green Knight* than they are to the accounts in *Roman de Brut*.
- C. several other *Mammillaria* species could survive in Tamaulipas in the future. Geoffrey of Monmouth was unaware of stories of the Round Table when composing his *History*, though historians know that works containing such stories were available to him.
- D. the genetic homogeneity of *M. anniana* decreased over time. Arthurian legends (tales related to the character of King Arthur) derive from many sources, such as *Englynion y Beddau*, composed between the 9th and 10th centuries, and *Sir Gawain and the Green Knight* from the 1300s. One of the most significant sources, Geoffrey of Monmouth's *History* of

the Kings of Britain, was written in Latin in the 1130s; some material from it was later adapted by the Norman poet Wace into the *Roman de Brut* in 1155. But while no source before 1155 includes references to the famous Round Table at which Arthur's knights assembled, both the *Roman de Brut* and Sir Thomas Malory's 15th-century compilation of Arthurian legends, *Le Morte d' Arthur*, do. It can therefore be inferred that Which choice most logically completes the text? *Le Morte d'Arthur* is more historically accurate than History, because Sir Gawain and the

Question 45

Source PDF page: 46

Green Knight had not been written when Geoffrey of Monmouth was writing his work. New Zealand has classified the rainbow lorikeet as an invasive species that could harm some of the country's native species. But researchers Alejandro Camacho and Jason McLachlan have pointed out that Earth's climate is changing in ways that challenge such classifications. Climate changes may force animals from their current ranges. Climate changes may also create good habitats in areas where a species couldn't live previously. These observations suggest that Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A. New Zealand was previously home to some rainbow lorikeets but they were outcompeted by invading species.
- B. even if Earth's climate doesn't change in the way scientists predict, the rainbow lorikeet will likely establish itself in New Zealand.
- C. labels like the one that New Zealand has applied to the rainbow lorikeet reflect environmental conditions that may not persist.
- D. it's useful at present for New Zealand to distinguish between invasive and native species in some instances but not in the case of the rainbow lorikeet.